

Summary Post

by [Abdulla Husain Salem Hadna Almessabi](#) - Tuesday, 4 November 2025, 4:09 PM

Number of replies: 0

The discussion was very informative and interesting for me. The debate over the Automated Active Response Weaponry case has brought up the major ethical, legal, and social issues regarding the creation of autonomous weapon systems. It is believed that Q Industries was unethical in granting lethal autonomy to the machines, as this breached the ACM Code of Ethics (2018) and the BCS Code of Conduct (2019). Such codes emphasize virtues like avoiding harm, enhancing human welfare, being honest, and serving the greater good (Schmitt, and Thurnher, 2013).

Legal aspects raised concerns with references to the Geneva Conventions and other regulations (Docherty, 2015), stating that it is only humans, rather than machines, that can be held responsible when making a decision in a war situation. Autonomous lethal systems undermine this principle and may lead to the violation of international humanitarian law (Docherty, 2020).

Cath (2018) had cautioned that this type of technology had the potential to destroy trust, silence freedom, and damage democracy upon its use in conjunction with other surveillance tools such as facial recognition. Some of the peers also mentioned that those employees who reported unethical practices were behaving in an ethical manner in accordance with the ACM Principle 1.7, which promotes reporting of actions that violate the public interest.

It was noted that morality should never be lost to technological prowess. Both the BCS and the ACM models bring out a very obvious point that ethical computing is all about human fundamental control, responsibility, and the preservation of life rather than innovation or profit.

References:

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